

Statement Fellowship Application

Applicant: Sage Arthur Jordan Clokey **Role:** State Director, Students For Liberty — California **Date:** June 2026

Project Name

The Living Age: Biology, Media, and the Case for Voluntary Order

One-Line Summary

A cross-disciplinary impact project that uses biological science and creative media to demonstrate that decentralized, voluntary order is not just a political ideal — it is how life itself works.

The Problem

The liberty movement loses its most capable people because it frames freedom as a political argument instead of a creative endeavor.

Engineers, biologists, designers, and builders leave because they are creators, not politicians. They don't want to fight the machine — they want to grow something that makes it irrelevant.

Meanwhile, the strongest empirical case for voluntary order sits untouched in the sciences. Every biology student already knows that centralized control in the body is called cancer. Every ecology student knows that monoculture plantations collapse while diverse forests endure for millennia. Every bioinformatics student works with systems where trillions of actors coordinate without a central planner.

They already understand emergent order — they just haven't connected it to political philosophy.

The liberty movement has a language problem. It speaks in politics to people who think in systems. The Living Age bridges that gap.

The Solution

The Living Age is built on two arms:

Media — Explain Why

A content platform — YouTube, essays, campus events, podcast appearances — that presents the case for voluntary order through the lens of biology, not ideology.

Core content themes:

- **“37 Trillion Cells, No Government”** — How your body coordinates trillions of actors without central planning, using local signals, voluntary exchange, and distributed knowledge — exactly the way Hayek described a free market
- **“Cancer Is Central Planning”** — What happens when one cell overrides the cooperative system and demands all resources flow to itself. This isn’t metaphor. This is peer-reviewed molecular biology
- **“The Open Source Economy of the Cell”** — How life runs a decentralized economy with no debt, no intellectual property, and no rent-seeking — for four billion years without a crash
- **“The Spiral and the Block”** — Two models of order across every scale: Fibonacci spirals (living, resilient, emergent) vs. grid blocks (rigid, brittle, imposed). Every civilization that organized as a block eventually collapsed. Every living system that organizes as a spiral is still here

The data comes from real biology: STRING protein-protein interaction networks, RegulonDB gene regulatory networks, KEGG metabolic pathways, and single-cell RNA sequencing.

Technology — Show How

A bioinformatics toolkit — genome analysis, protein interaction mapping, living systems design — that demonstrates voluntary order is not only natural but designable. Built on real APIs and databases: UCSC Genome Browser, NCBI Entrez, ESM-3 protein language models, AlphaFold.

My capstone research at UCSC, *Genomic Ledger Synthesis*, proposes a framework for constructing genomes the way nature actually builds them — through distributed, consensus-validated transactions rather than top-down central planning. The genome is modeled as a distributed ledger where functional modules are integrated iteratively, validated by biological consensus (growth), and optimized through in vivo rearrangement. It applies Hayek’s knowledge problem,

Mises' calculation problem, and Kirznerian entrepreneurial discovery directly to molecular biology — and it works because biology already operates on these principles.

The technology arm proves that the distributed, entrepreneurial components of biology — local, adaptive, signal-responsive — are the designable ones. The centralized, hub-dependent components are brittle. This is the data that makes the philosophical argument undeniable.

Why This Fellowship

Dr. von Laer wrote that the Statement Fellowship is for people “ready to lead projects with the potential to create meaningful change” and who have “the ambition to build a legacy that will stand the test of time.”

The Living Age is that kind of project. It is not a campaign. It is not a policy paper. It is a permanent shift in how the liberty movement makes its case — from arguing against the state to demonstrating from the hardest evidence there is that voluntary order is how life works.

Every component of the fellowship maps to what this project needs:

Mentorship from founders, entrepreneurs, and movement leaders. I've already begun connecting with people at this intersection. At SynBioBeta 2026, I met Drew Endy — professor of bioengineering at Stanford, fellow at the Hoover Institution — and discussed how to do synthetic biology in ways aligned with voluntary principles. The overlap between decentralized biology and libertarian philosophy is natural. These people already think in emergent systems. They need the philosophical language, and we need their technical language. The fellowship's mentor network would deepen these connections.

A rigorous foundation in Austrian economics. Austrian economics is not just context for this project — it is the theoretical engine. The entire Living Age thesis rests on the claim that Hayek, Mises, and Menger described principles that are not merely economic but biological. Cells act on distributed knowledge. Genomes coordinate through price-like signals (metabolic shadow prices). Ecosystems self-organize through spontaneous order. The fellowship's economic training would sharpen the argument where it matters most.

AI tools to multiply impact. I already use Claude as a core creative and research tool. The Living Age Trilogy — over 100 chapters across three books connecting biology, philosophy, mythology, and Austrian economics — was drafted with AI as a

collaborator. My bioinformatics workflow integrates AI for protein analysis, literature synthesis, and content production. The fellowship's AI resources would scale what I've already proven works.

Milestone-based funding. The Living Age is designed to be high-impact and low-cost. All bioinformatics tools are open-source or free-tier. Content production uses existing equipment. But scaling — travel for campus events across California, recording equipment for documenting talks as content, conference attendance for cross-pollination, web hosting for the platform — requires resources I don't currently have. Milestone-based funding is the right structure: fund what works, measure what matters, cut what doesn't.

The Spring 2027 retreat. The Living Age is an inherently connective project. It needs people from multiple disciplines — biology, economics, philosophy, engineering, media — to see themselves as part of the same pattern. An in-person retreat with 25-30 other fellows building ambitious projects is exactly the environment where those connections form.

What I've Already Built

This is not a proposal for something I plan to start. The Living Age is already in motion.

The Trilogy

Three books, over 100 chapters, connecting:

- **Book I — The Sagent Creed:** A philosophical framework for individual conscience, voluntary order, and the Fibonacci spiral as a pattern of life. Covers the Clokey family legacy, the architecture of a free conscience, and the generational pattern of seed-planting
- **Book II — The Spiral and the Block:** The mythology of media — how Star Wars, Avatar, Lord of the Rings, Clone Wars, and the Assassin's Creed series all encode the same pattern: centralized control fails, decentralized life endures. Eight Pillars of the Living Age drawn from this synthesis
- **Book III — The Spiral Steward:** Austrian economics meets molecular biology. How spontaneous order works in the cell. Why genome browsers are hard to use. Evolution as proactive creation. The design for LivingWorks — a CAD system for the Living Age

The Capstone

Genomic Ledger Synthesis: A Distributed Framework for Eukaryotic Genome Construction — my BME 129C capstone at UC Santa Cruz. A peer-reviewed-quality paper proposing that genome construction should follow the distributed, consensus-validated architecture of natural evolution rather than top-down central planning. Integrates Sc2.0 SCRaMbLE, cell-free assembly, Flux Balance Analysis shadow prices, and microbial consortium architecture into a unified synthesis protocol.

The State Director Infrastructure

As California State Director for SFL, I've already built:

- A **90-day strategy** organized by bioregion (NorCal, Bay Area, Central Valley, SoCal) using mycelium network architecture — lateral communication, shared resources, no central command
- A **Socratic event template** — “Is Nature Libertarian?” — designed for any campus, any audience, adaptable to biology, philosophy, business, or general students
- A **tabling playbook** built on questions, not pamphlets: “How does a forest organize itself without a manager?” “What happens when one cell in your body tries to centralize control?”
- An **outreach pipeline** and **contact log** tracking every campus relationship across California
- A **summer 2026 conference chain trip** — FreedomFest (Las Vegas), Approaching Humanity (Phoenix), FEE Summer Campus (Maryland), YALCON (Cincinnati) — completed in July, a two-week cross-pollination run across four states

The Clokey Legacy

I am the grandson of Art Clokey, the creator of Gumby — a man who showed the world that clay could come alive. He didn't optimize clay. He didn't deploy clay. He breathed life into it. His studio was called Premavision: universal love made visible.

My father, Joe Clokey, spent eight years fighting the entertainment industry to protect Gumby's soul. He died before he finished.

The inheritance is not the character. It is the ability to bring life to inert material. Clay to code. Story to system. Art gave motion to clay. I want to give language to biology — the language that connects what every living system already knows to what the liberty movement has been trying to say in the wrong vocabulary for decades.

12-Month Milestone Plan

Quarter 1 (Months 1-3): Plant the Roots

Milestone	Deliverable	Metric
Campus launch	3 “Is Nature Libertarian?” events at California campuses	100+ attendees total
Content foundation	YouTube channel launched with 3 biology-liberty videos	2,000+ views
Network seeding	Identify and connect 15+ STEM students to liberty-aligned work/networks	Active group chat
Written content	3 published essays on the biology-liberty connection	Published on SFL blog + Living Age site
Austrian foundation	Complete fellowship economics curriculum	—

Quarter 2 (Months 4-6): Water What’s Alive

Milestone	Deliverable	Metric
Campus expansion	5 additional events, including 2 outside California through SFL network	300+ cumulative attendees
Content growth	5 additional videos, including “Cancer Is Central Planning” short-form series	10,000+ cumulative views
Toolkit release	Open-source bioinformatics notebooks showing decentralized order in real biological data	Published on GitHub
Replicable format	“Is Nature Libertarian?” event kit published for any SFL chapter to use	3+ chapters adopting
Cross-pollination	Present at 1 conference (FreedomFest, LibertyCon, or ISFLC)	—

Quarter 3 (Months 7-9): Let It Grow

Milestone	Deliverable	Metric
Book publication	Book I of the Living Age Trilogy (The Sagent Creed) published	Available in print + digital
Technology prototype	LivingWorks v0.1 — genome analysis interface demonstrating distributed order	Live demo
National reach	Events hosted at 5+ campuses outside California	500+ cumulative attendees
Media features	Podcast appearances or guest content on 3+ liberty-aligned platforms	—
Mentor integration	Working relationship with 2+ mentors from fellowship network on specific project components	—

Quarter 4 (Months 10-12): The Harvest

Milestone	Deliverable	Metric
Full platform	Living Age website with content library, event resources, and toolkit	Live site
Movement integration	“Is Nature Libertarian?” established as a recognized SFL event format globally	10+ chapters using it
Content library	15+ videos, 10+ essays, open-source code, event recordings	25,000+ cumulative views
Network	50+ STEM students connected across campuses through the Living Age network	Self-sustaining lateral communication
Legacy document	Year-end report proving the biology-liberty bridge works as a recruitment and education tool	Submitted to SFL

Beyond Year 1

The Living Age is designed to outlast any single funding period. Event templates are replicable — any SFL chapter can run “Is Nature Libertarian?” with the materials we publish. The content compounds: every essay, video, and visualization becomes a permanent resource. The mycelium network of STEM-liberty students, once connected, sustains itself laterally. The trilogy continues. The technology deepens. The first year plants the roots. The network grows from there.

Budget Framework

Category	Year 1 Estimate	Notes
Campus events (materials, venue, printing)	\$1,500	10-15 events across California + expansion states
Travel (campus visits, conferences)	\$3,000	California campuses + 2-3 national conferences
Recording equipment	\$800	Portable camera, mic, lighting for documenting events as content
Web hosting and platform	\$300	Domain, hosting, design for Living Age site
Book publication (editing, formatting, printing)	\$1,500	Book I of the trilogy — print + digital
Software and tools	\$400	Premium tiers for design, editing, analytics
Total	\$7,500	

All bioinformatics tools (UCSC Genome Browser, NCBI Entrez, STRING, AlphaFold) are free. AI tools (Claude) are already in my workflow. Content production builds on existing equipment. This is a high-impact, low-cost project by design — every dollar funds something that compounds.

What Makes This Different

Most liberty content argues *against* something. The Living Age argues *from* something — from the evidence that life itself is organized on voluntary, decentralized principles.

This is not ideology projected onto nature. This is nature revealing the principle that the liberty movement has been arguing about in the wrong language for decades.

The shift:

- From **“government is bad”** to **“how does a forest organize itself without a manager?”**
- From **political debates** to **interdisciplinary discovery**
- From **recruiting libertarians** to **connecting people who already think in systems**
- From **arguments against the state** to **evidence from life itself**

The people who walk away saying “I’ve never heard it put that way” are worth more than a hundred sign-ups who forget by Tuesday.

Seeds, not pamphlets. Spirals, not blocks.

Video Script (1 Minute)

For the video component of the application, if required:

Dr. von Laer, you said you’re looking for coordinators ready to lead projects that create meaningful change. Here’s mine.

I just graduated from UC Santa Cruz with a degree in bioinformatics. I study how living systems organize themselves. And here’s what nobody in the liberty movement is talking about:

Your body is 37 trillion cells. No president. No congress. No central plan. They coordinate through local signals, voluntary exchange, and distributed knowledge — exactly the way Hayek described a free market. And when one cell overrides that system — when it centralizes control and demands all resources flow to itself — we have a word for that. Cancer.

This isn’t a metaphor. This is peer-reviewed molecular biology. Genomes don’t evolve by random accident — they restructure themselves from the bottom up, rearranging existing parts in new combinations. Life is an engineer, not a lottery.

The strongest case for liberty isn’t in an economics textbook. It’s in every living thing on earth. And no one is putting it on camera.

I’m the grandson of Art Clokey — the man who created Gumby. He showed the world that clay could come alive. I want to show the world that the science of life proves what the liberty movement has been arguing in the wrong language for decades.

The Living Age. Media explains why. Technology shows how. Biology is the proof.

Closing

The creation of the Living Age requires media to explain why and technology to show how.

SFL gave me the network. California gave me the campuses. UC Santa Cruz gave me the science. The Clokey name gave me the inheritance. This fellowship would give me the mentorship, the accountability, and the resources to turn what already exists into something that lasts.

I am not proposing an idea. I am proposing to scale something I've already built — with the people, the structure, and the support to make it reach everyone it was meant to reach.

Life is the proof. The spiral is the method. The Living Age is the name.

Sage Arthur Jordan Clokey State Director, Students For Liberty — California B.S. Bioinformatics, UC Santa Cruz (2026) June 2026